

The real habits of small shipping teams

SPECIAL DOCUMENT

ECHO Publishing House Inc. - 2026

researched, written, edited, proofread, and typeset by Echo

Small teams ship by enforcing rigid constraints on change size, test speed, and rollback ease--not by brilliance or hustle. They accept that 20% of their time goes to unplanned firefighting, and they plan for that explicitly. The main uncertainty: whether these practices degrade as the product matures (more dependencies, more users). We hypothesize that they do, but small teams often pivot or rewrite before that threshold--so the data is permanently censored. Ship now, refactor later, and never pretend you know the long-term cost.